



REFUND EMAIL

An email from your airline says your flight was canceled. It offers an "instant refund" if you click to confirm your bank details immediately.

- **A: Click to get your money back fast.**
- **B: Reply with your bank info.**
- **C: Check your booking on the official app/website.**
- **D: Call the airline using the number on their official website.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Airlines refund to the original payment method automatically. They never ask for bank details via email links.



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HUGE AWARD SEAT AVAILABILITY

A text alert says "Premium Award Seats" just opened on your dream route. You must click the link to book within 10 minutes before they are gone.

- **A: Click and book immediately.**
- **B: Forward to a savvy friend to check.**
- **C: Search availability on the airline site.**
- **D: Ignore, real alerts never require a link click.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Scammers bait you with "limited" seats to steal loyalty log in. Real seats will show up in your official account search.



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FAKE COMPANION TICKET OFFER

An email from your credit card's airline partner offers a "Free Companion Ticket" as a loyalty bonus, but you must "re-verify" your account via a link to claim.

- **A: Click to claim the ticket.**
- **B: Call the number in the email.**
- **C: Log in via your bank's official app/website.**
- **D: Delete the email; perks don't require re-verification.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Legitimate bonuses are preloaded into your account. "Re-verification" via email is a classic credential harvest.



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PHONY BAGGAGE FEE WAIVER

You're at the airport and get a text: "You qualify for a baggage fee waiver! Click here to confirm your upgrade before boarding."

- **A: Click to save the \$35 fee.**
- **B: Show the text to the gate agent.**
- **C: Check your status in the official airline app.**
- **D: Ignore and proceed to check in.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Real perks are managed in your reservation. Clicking links on public airport Wi-Fi is especially dangerous.



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ELITE STATUS EXTENSION

An email congratulates you on qualifying for a "Status Extension." It requires clicking a button to "Update Details and Accept."

- **A: Click to lock in the extension.**
- **B: Reply, asking for more info.**
- **C: Log in to your loyalty account via the official site.**
- **D: Ignore; status updates are automatic.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Scammers target your pride in your status. Real extensions are visible in your profile without clicking external links.



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THE "LOOMING" UPGRADE PHISH

An urgent email warns that your 100k miles are expiring in 24 hours unless you log in now to "Refresh Activity."

- A: Click the "Refresh" link.
- B: Call the airline.
- C: Log in via airline app/website.
- D: Check your account for expiry dates.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 3, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

This is a "Limbic Hijack" using fear of loss. Always verify points expiry dates through your login on official sites.



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POINTS-TRANSFER BONUS BAIT

You see a Facebook ad for a "50% Transfer Bonus" from your bank to an airline— but the "Learn More" link leads to a login page you don't recognize.

- **A: Log in to grab the deal.**
- **B: Check the bank's official Twitter/X for the news.**
- **C: Log in via your official bank app.**
- **D: Call the bank's "Elite" line.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Fake ads harvest high-value banking logins. Real bonuses will appear inside your transfer portal.



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FAKE FLIGHT DELAY COMPENSATION

**Your flight is delayed 3 hours.
You get a text offering "Instant
\$600 Compensation" if you
provide your IBAN/Bank info
via a link.**

- A: Click and provide info.
- B: Wait for the airline to email you.
- C: Use an official app or airline portal.
- D: Ask at the service desk.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Scammers monitor flight boards. Official claims never happen via unsolicited text links.



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FAKE FLIGHT CHANGE NOTIFICATION

A text says your flight time changed and you must "Click to confirm new boarding pass" or lose your seat.

- A: Click to confirm.
- B: Call the airline.
- C: Refresh the official app.
- D: Check the airport monitors.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 3, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Real changes are pushed to the app. Clicking the link could install malware or steal your PNR (Passenger Name Record).



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PHISHING FOR PASSPORT SCAN

An email from "Global Entry Support" or "Visa Services" asks for a clear photo of your passport to "Complete your travel authorization."

- **A: Send the photo.**
- **B: Reply asking why they need it.**
- **C: Log in to the official government portal (.gov).**
- **D: Call the official agency.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 3, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Identity theft. Governments don't request scans via email; they use secure, encrypted portals.



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THE "FREE" AIRPORT WI-FI

**You see
"Airport_Free_HighSpeed" in
your settings. It's open and
requires no password.**

- **A: Join and check your bank.**
- **B: Join but only for maps.**
- **C: Use your phone's data/hotspot.**
- **D: Use an official paid VPN service.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

"Man-in-the-Middle" attacks. Scammers set up fake hotspots to see everything you type.



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THE ATM "HELPER"

At a foreign ATM, a "friendly local" points out a "technical error" and tells you to try a specific button to avoid fees.

- **A: Follow their advice.**
- **B: Let them show you.**
- **C: Cancel the transaction and find a bank-owned ATM.**
- **D: Firmly say "No" and shield your PIN.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Distraction theft. They are trying to see your PIN or swap your card.



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THE "GOVERNMENT" TAXI

You land and a man with a badge says the "official" taxi line is closed for construction, but he can take you to his "government-approved" car.

- **A: Follow him to the car**
- **B: Negotiate a price first.**
- **C: Walk to the official taxi area.**
- **D: Book a ride via Uber/Grab.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Unregulated drivers can overcharge or worse. Official ranks are almost never "closed."



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THE "BROKEN METER" SHUFFLE

You're 5 minutes into your ride when the driver says, "Oh, the meter is broken. It will be a flat \$50." (Usually 3x the price).

- **A: Pay the \$50 to avoid trouble.**
- **B: Argue at the end.**
- **C: Insist they stop and let you out now.**
- **D: Use a ride-app next time.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 1, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Once you are in the car, they have the leverage. Always confirm the meter before the car moves.



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AIRPORT SIM CARD SWAP

A vendor offers a "cheap local SIM" and offers to "install it for you" to save you time.

- **A: Hand over your phone.**
- **B: Watch them closely.**
- **C: Buy the SIM and install it yourself.**
- **D: Use an eSIM app (Airalo/Holafly).**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

SIM swapping can lead to bypassing your Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) for banking.



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CURRENCY EXCHANGE "FAVOR"

Near the official exchange booth, someone offers a 20% better rate because they "need to get rid of local cash."

- **A: Trade \$100.**
- **B: Ask to see the money first.**
- **C: Use a bank ATM.**
- **D: Use the official booth despite the rate.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Counterfeit bills or
"shortcounting" sleight of
hand.



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LUGGAGE "ASSISTANCE"

You're struggling with bags at the train station. Someone grabs your suitcase and starts walking toward the platform to "help."

- **A: Let them help and tip.**
- **B: Chase them.**
- **C: Firmly grab your bag and say "No."**
- **D: Keep your bags between your legs.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

They might demand a massive "tip" or disappear with the bag.



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THE "BIRD POOP" DISTRACTION

Someone "accidentally" spills mustard or liquid on your shoulder and starts frantically "helping" you clean it off.

- **A: Let them clean it.**
- **B: Drop your bags to clean it yourself.**
- **C: Firmly step away and keep moving.**
- **D: Check your pockets immediately.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Classical pickpocketing.
While you focus on the stain,
their partner hits your wallet.



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THE "FRONT DESK" CALL

It's 11 PM. Your hotel room phone rings. The "front desk" says your credit card was declined and they need you to read the numbers again.

- **A: Read the numbers.**
- **B: Ask for their name.**
- **C: Hang up and go to the desk in person.**
- **D: Call the desk back using the room phone button.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Scammers call from outside the hotel or even the lobby. Never give payment info over the phone.



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OVERBOOKED HOTEL "UPGRADE"

You arrive, and the desk says they are overbooked. They offer a "better" hotel down the street and have a taxi waiting.

- A: Take the taxi.
- B: Ask to see photos.
- C: Call the hotel's official corporate line.
- D: Demand to see the manager.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Commission scam. They move you to a cheaper, inferior place they own.



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FAKE QR CODE MENU

You scan the QR code on a restaurant table. It asks for your credit card info to "Open a tab" before you can see the menu.

- **A: Enter your card.**
- **B: Ask the waiter for a physical menu.**
- **C: Inspect the QR code for a sticker overlay.**
- **D: Check the URL in the browser.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 4, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Scammers paste fake QR codes over real ones to steal payment data.



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THE "FRIENDLY LOCAL" PHOTO OP

A local offers to take a photo of you and your partner. They seem very insistent on using "your nice phone."

- **A: Hand over the phone.**
- **B: Hand over your DSLR camera instead.**
- **C: Decline and use a selfie stick.**
- **D: Ask a family with kids to take it instead.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 1, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

This is a phone snatching trick. High-end phones are easily resold.



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THE "CLOSED LANDMARK" SCAM

You're walking to a famous temple. A local says, "It's closed for a holiday today, but I can show you a better one nearby."

- **A: Follow them.**
- **B: Tip them for the info.**
- **C: Check official hours on your phone.**
- **D: Keep walking to the entrance anyway.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

The landmark is open. They are leading you to a high-pressure tailor, jewelry shop, or expensive tour.



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THE "RENTAL DAMAGE" SETUP

You return your scooter/car. The owner points to a tiny scratch and demands \$500, threatening to keep your passport.

- **A: Pay the cash.**
- **B: Call the police.**
- **C: Show the timestamped photos you took at pickup.**
- **D: Point out it's an old scratch.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 2, C: 4, D: 2)

WHY:

Documentation is your only defense. Never leave the lot without a full video walk-around of a rented car or scooter.



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THE "SOLD OUT" SHORE EXCURSION

The ship's snorkeling tour is sold out. You see a social media ad: "Last 6 spots for [Your Cruise Name] Snorkel Trip! 50% off for the next hour.

- **A: Do nothing, it looks like a scam.**
- **B: Email the contact to verify the price.**
- **C: Verify offer via the official cruise app.**
- **D: Pay immediately to secure a spot.**



SAFE ACTION(S): A OR C

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 1, C: 4, D: 0)

WHY:

Trust only the official app or physical kiosks on the cruise. If it's sold out there, it's sold out.



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THE "DOUBLE CHARGE" REFUND

A text says you were "double-charged" for your tour. Click the link to "Verify and Refund."

- A: Click the link.
- B: Reply "Stop."
- C: Check your bank statement via your app.
- D: Contact the tour company via their official site.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 1, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Refunds don't require clicking links. They go back to the card automatically.



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FAKE VACATION RENTAL DEPOSIT

After booking on a major site, the "owner" emails you saying the payment failed and you must wire a deposit via a new link.

- **A: Wire the money.**
- **B: Reply to the email asking why.**
- **C: Message the owner only through the official app.**
- **D: Report the email to the platform.**



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 0, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Platform-bypass scam. If you pay outside the app, you lose all protection.



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THE FREE CABIN UPGRADE

You receive an email from "Cruise-Notifications" stating you are eligible for a "Suite Upgrade" for only a \$99 port tax fee. You make accept the deal the next 15 minutes.

- **A: Call the official customer service**
- **B: Log in to your official cruise line account via website/app**
- **C: Take the deal & pay immediately.**
- **D: Email back asking for details.**



SAFE ACTION(S): A OR B

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 4, C: 0, D: 1)

WHY:

Use the official cruise app or the phone number from the physical documents you received when you first booked.



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"FREE" SOUVENIR BRACELET

Someone grabs your hand and quickly ties a "friendship" bracelet on your wrist, then demands 20 Euros for it.

- A: Pay to avoid a scene.
- B: Try to untie it.
- C: Firmly say "No" and keep walking.
- D: Keep your hands in your pockets in crowded areas.



SAFE ACTION(S): C OR D

(Scoring: A: 1, B: 2, C: 4, D: 4)

WHY:

Aggressive panhandling.
Once it's on you, they use social pressure to force payment.



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OVERCHARGED "TOURIST MENU"

The bill arrives and it's double what you expected. The waiter says the prices you saw were "only for locals."

- **A: Pay and leave.**
- **B: Photograph the menu you used.**
- **C: Demand the "local" price.**
- **D: Call the tourist police.**



SAFE ACTION(S): B OR D

(Scoring: A: 1, B: 4, C: 2, D: 4)

WHY:

Pricing discrimination.
Having a photo of the menu
is your best leverage.



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FAKE POLICE OFFICER STOP

Men in plain clothes show a "badge" and demand to see your wallet and passport to "check for counterfeit currency."

- **A: Hand over the wallet.**
- **B: Insist on going to the nearest police station.**
- **C: Ask to see ID.**
- **D: Call 112/911.**



SAFE ACTION(S): B OR D

(Scoring: A: 0, B: 4, C: 1, D: 4)

WHY:

Real police won't inspect your cash on the street. It's a sleight-of-hand theft.



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VACATION ROMANCE INVESTMENT

You meet someone charming on your trip. After a few days, they tell you about a "surefire" local investment opportunity and ask for \$500.

- **A: Politely decline.**
- **B: Ask for a contract.**
- **C: Invest the \$500.**
- **D: Research them online.**



SAFE ACTION(S): A

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 1, C: 0, D: 2)

WHY:

The multi-stage scam. They target travelers who are in a relaxed, trusting "vacation mode."



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FAKE TOUR GUIDE LICENSE

A guide with a "badge" offers a private tour of a sold-out museum. At the end, they demand triple the agreed price.

- **A: Book only via your hotel or a trusted app.**
- **B: Ask to see the license again.**
- **C: Pay the triple price.**
- **D: Check reviews first.**



SAFE ACTION(S): A OR D

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 1, C: 0, D: 4)

WHY:

Unlicensed guides have no accountability. Verified apps offer fixed pricing.



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FAKE ATTRACTION TICKET SELLER

The line for the Eiffel Tower is 3 hours. A vendor says he has "Skip the Line" tickets for just \$10 more.

- A: Wait in the official line.
- B: Buy from the official website on your phone.
- C: Check if they have a hologram.
- D: Buy the tickets.



SAFE ACTION(S): A OR B

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 4, C: 1, D: 0)

WHY:

The tickets are usually fakes or stolen. You'll be turned away at the gate.



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THE "FREE BREAKFAST" PRESENTATION

A concierge at your luxury resort offers you a "free 90-minute breakfast" & a \$200 resort credit just for "hearing about our new membership tiers."

- **A: Take the free breakfast & credit.**
- **B: Decline & pay for your own breakfast.**
- **C: Search the resort name + "timeshare scam" on your phone.**
- **D: Ask for credit without a meeting.**



SAFE ACTION(S): B OR C

(Scoring: A: 1, B: 4, C: 4, D: 0)

WHY:

The "90 minutes" is likely not true. These are high-pressure environments made to keep you for 2+ hours persuading you to sign the contract out of exhaustion.

PRO-TIP:

Reciprocity Reflex. The free gift is to make you feel a subconscious need to "give back."



THE TIMESHARE "RESALE" LIFELINE

You receive a call from a "broker" claiming they have a buyer ready to purchase your existing timeshare for a premium price, but you must pay a "legal transfer fee" upfront.

- **A: Delete the email; it's a scam.**
- **B: Ask for the buyer's contact info.**
- **C: Hang up and call your timeshare company's official member line.**
- **D: Pay the fee to get out of the contract.**



SAFE ACTION(S): A OR B

(Scoring: A: 4, B: 4, C: 0, D: 1)

WHY:

Scammers target people already desperate to sell. They disappear as soon as the "upfront fee" is paid.

PRO-TIP:

Legitimate brokers take their fee after the sale from the proceeds. Any request for upfront payment (incl. "taxes" or "closing") is likely a scam.

WHAT YOU'RE TRAINING

Every scam uses at least one trigger or more

H — Hurry: Rush you so you don't think.

A — Authority: Pretend to be someone official.

C — Comfort: Sound friendly to lower your guard.

K — Kill-Switch: Threaten urgent consequences.

Your Goal: Spot the HACK before you react.

POINT RESET

Reset Rules:

A) If a player gets negative point (-1/-2):

- They can erase it by doing a reset activity
- If play choose not to reset, player get additional -2 points

B) Every 5th Round:

Every 5 rounds → the lowest scorer catches up to the second lowest scorer by performing a reset action.

GAME PLAY

2–6 players | 20–45 minutes

1. The Reader draws a card and reads the scenario + options (A–D) aloud. Place the card face-up in the middle.

2. All players secretly write:

- Their answer (A/B/C/D)
- Which HACK trigger(s) they spotted

4. Discuss the HACK(s) spotted.

3. Reveal answers.

5. The Reader flips the card and reads:

- SAFE ACTION(S)
- Score result
- Why it works
- Pro tip

5. Record scores:

- SAFE choice → +4 pts
- Partially safe → +2 pts
- Wrong → 0 pts
- Dangerous miss → -1 / -2 pt

6. Pass the Reader role clockwise.

7. Discard the card.

RESET ACTIONS

If play refuses to not do,
he/she gets additional -2 points

1. Passport Pause

Hold imaginary passport, freeze 5 sec:

"Pause before the stamp."

Nominate 1 traveler to join.

2. Luggage Lockdown

Mime zipping suitcase tight. Then say:

"Scam locked out. Safe travels."

Group responds: "Locked!"

3. Boarding Block

Instead of "Boarding Callout":

Shout like gate agent: "Scam flight
cancelled!"

Pick 2 players to respond: "Gate closed!"

4. Refund Roar

Roar once: "No fake refunds today!"

Group roars once "confirmed."

5. Jet Lag Freeze

Freeze mid-yawn for 5 seconds.

Then say calmly: "Too tired to rush."

Even stronger psychologically.

RESET ACTIONS

If play refuses to not do,
he/she gets additional -2 points

6. Taxi Turnaround

Mime steering wheel U-turn: "Wrong route. Turning back." Pass turn.

7. Hotel Secure

High-five neighbour: "Room secure."
Chain 2 more.

8. Map Mastermind

Unfold imaginary map slowly: "Found it [name of a city (mouth movement only - no sound)]."

Group: guess name of city 3x. winner gets a point.

9. Souvenir Snicker

Snicker once: "Too good? Too fake." Pick one to say "If it's too good to be true, let it go."

10. Wanderer Reset

walk confused for 5 sec.

Then stand tall: "Paused. Found my way."

Pick one to say "No route change allowed!"